> textbook produced for Class III in 1963, a separate chapter was devoted each to Jesus, the Hindu God Ram and Buddha, along with chapters on the holy Prophet of the Muslims. Jesus, Ram and Buddha, who were later excised from social studies textbooks, and their religions denigrated as false, appear in the Ayub era textbook as positive characters who represented peace, justice, humanity, generosity, kindness and truth. (2003, p. 26)

However, the role of Islam was key in promoting the 'right values' (Saigol 2003, p. 11). The emphasis on Islam is clearly highlighted in the following excerpt from the Commission report:

> National unity and religious values have to be translated into deeds in a manner that all our citizens can accept them and join in the common effort. Islam teaches honesty in thought, in deed and in purpose. It lays emphasis on social justice and active participation in the removal of distress and poverty. In short it seeks the identification of those who know with those who do not know, of those who have with those who do not have, of those who are powerful with those who have no power. These are tasks which can unite all of us, and it is through identification of all our problems and all our citizens that we shall find real unity. (Ministry of Education 1992, p. 2, quoting from the Commission on National Education 1959)

The promotion of this Islamic unity was propagated through the education system. A 'uniform school curriculum' was introduced to promote 'national unity', and 'religious education' was made 'compulsory at elementary school', with 'social studies' teaching about 'rights and responsibilities', 'problems facing Pakistan' and the importance of being 'useful and loyal citizens' (Dean 2005, p. 37). However, under Ayub Khan the use of religion in schools remained 'symbolic', similar to his successor Yahya Khan who again paid 'lip service to Islam' (Rahman 2004, pp. 14–16). Whether or not these rulers were simply paying 'lip service' to Islam for the purpose of promoting national unity, or appeasing the religious elite, the use of religion in education by so-called secular leaders was instrumental in normalizing a citizenship discourse that equated national identity with religion. This problem was also evident under Z. A. Bhutto's education policies. At a time when the separation of East Pakistan had challenged the 'two nation theory' and the idea of the Islamic Republic, Bhutto, to both appease the Islamic conservatives and push forth his agenda of 'Islamic socialism', made the education curriculum more Islam centric (Mohammad-Arif 2005; Rahman 1998), introducing compulsory *Islamiyat* in all schools. To further appease the religious lobby, Bhutto declared Friday as a national holiday, and established the Federal Ulama